



Rotting inspiration!

Goethe could not write unless he had a rotting apple on his desk.
<http://dgit.in/1LdnRTe>



The Raspberry Pi 2 coupled with OpenELEC is all you need

Minix Neo boxes are great, extremely versatile. The X8-H Plus hardware is way ahead of the competition as it has a card reader, OTG port, three USB ports, a detachable antenna, ethernet port and provision for analog and digital A/V output. The only sore point? Its cost.

Building your own streaming stick

With the low-cost advantage of a Raspberry Pi, DIY enthusiast can make their own video streaming server. It's not that hard. Just choose a variant of KODI and start adding apps to enhance the experience. KODI works seamlessly with a lot of devices without the need to too much customisation as is the case with most linux distros. The interface is easy to understand and you can use your Android phone as a remote.

If you wait till Windows 10 rolls out, which is going to be sometime this year, each Raspberry Pi 2 gets a lean version of the OS for free, meant for casting and streaming. All you need is a Wi-Fi adapter (TP-Link), 8 GB Sandisk Ultra MicroSD card for the OS image. KODI does have Airplay support straight out of the box, in case you have an Apple device to stream on to.



KODI is what most media centre linux distros are based on

So, yeah, if it were up to nerds to look at all that we have at our disposal, it would be very difficult to pass on the Raspberry as a complete package to build your own streaming server so to speak. ■

INDIE ZEN FOR DUMMIES

You wanna be an Indie Game Dev? A rogue, a ronin in a world full of multinational companies. Great. Here are my thoughts after more than 10 years working as a freelance author and game designer:

THE FOUR NOBLE TRUTHS OF INDIE GAME DEV

- #1: The Indie Life is all about Suffering.
- #2: You perfectly know the sources of this Suffering. The tax system, the difficulty to find contracts, your own doubts, etc. And trust me: all of this suffering starts from day one.
- #3: We can put an end to all Suffering by identifying its Origin.
- #4: To accomplish this, you just have to take the Eightfold Path.

THE EIGHTFOLD PATH

First, you need to acquire wisdom by having the Right View and Intention. The Right View isn't only about having a great understanding of the video games industry, but first and foremost about having understood your own capacities. The Right Intention is to know why you want to be an Indie. What do you want to achieve? Make a lot of money? Obtain glory? Have fun? Just try to find something meaningful for yourself.

Second, you need to follow an ethical conduct. Starting with Right Speech, first. Because you are your own company, don't mess with your conduct and your attitude when you meet people. Also, always honour a contract. Your word is your bond. Never forget about it. By taking the Right Action: always act carefully. No matter the decision, think twice, choose and move on. Most of the time, the Right Action is to act. Stagnation is Death. Choose to have a Right Livelihood. Believe me, a rupee is a rupee. Never pour money down the drain. Never. Even and especially if you have some. Also, always take care of yourself. If you are exhausted, take a break.

Third, you need to improve your concentration. Always make the Right Effort. Don't waste time. If you think that you have some, think twice. Why not start another project? Why not improve your skills? Also you must have the Right Mindfulness. By Mindfulness, I mean focus. You must always stay focused on your objectives. Having a meaningful Right Intention at the start of your journey helps a lot. Finally, you will acquire the Right Concentration and you will be aware of every small details of both your professional and personal life.

THE ENLIGHTENMENT?

Being an Indie game dev is a real Journey. Both a professional and a personal one. Embracing the Four Noble Truth and following the Eightfold Path doesn't protect you from failure but, for sure, it will allow you to do your best and to make this journey a wonderful and meaningful one. *Om mani padme hum.* ■



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